

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT) Feedback

NAME

DATE

Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

Teens primarily | Brain-Based Fit: Moderate — Skills Are Useful

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

DBT teaches four skill sets: Mindfulness (being present-focused), Distress Tolerance (surviving a crisis without making it worse), Emotion Regulation (understanding and managing emotions), and Interpersonal Effectiveness (navigating relationships). The adolescent version adds "Walking the Middle Path" for families. Unlike CBT, some DBT skills work through the body — distress tolerance techniques like ice, paced breathing, and intense exercise directly calm the nervous system without requiring the child to think their way through it.

Caregiver Involvement:

Included in the adolescent version (DBT-A). Caregivers attend the skills group alongside the teen and learn the same skills. This means the whole family shares a common language for managing emotions and crises.

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your teen has intense emotional reactions, self-harm, or difficulty managing crises
- Emotional dysregulation is the primary concern
- You want concrete, practical skills (not just "talk about feelings")
- You are willing to learn and practice the skills alongside your teen

Brain-Based Consideration

:Full DBT is complex and demanding: weekly individual therapy, weekly skills group, between-session coaching calls, and homework. This is a heavy load for any family. The body-based distress tolerance skills are often the most accessible and effective piece for brain-based differences. A modified, simplified approach using selected DBT skills may work better than the full protocol. Ask the therapist: "Can we focus on the skills that match my child's abilities?"

1. Is what is written accurate?

Yes

No

Yes

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)?

Thank you for your feedback!